Specification of the fifty-one controlled designations of origin "Alsace grand cru"

approved by decree no. 2011-1373 of 25 October 2011, amended by order of 20 June 2016 (JORF of 29 June 2016), amended by order of 9 May 2022 (JORF of 13 May 2022), amended by order of 4 July 2024 (JORF of 7 July 2024)

"ALSACE GRAND CRU ALTENBERG DE BERGHEIM" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU BRAND" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU EICHBERG" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU FLORIMONT" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU FROEHN" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU FURSTENTUM" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU GEISBERG" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU GLOECKELBERG" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU GOLDERT" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU HATSCHBOURG" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU HENGST" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU KAEFFERKOPF" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU KANZLERBERG" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU KESSLER" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU KIRCHBERG DE RIBEAUVILLE" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU KITTERLE" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU MAMBOURG" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU MANDELBERG" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU MARCKRAIN" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU OLLWILLER" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU OSTERBERG" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU PFERSIGBERG" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU PFINGSTBERG" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU RANGEN" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU ROSACKER" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU SAERING" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU SCHLOSSBERG" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU SCHOENENBOURG" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU SOMMERBERG" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU SONNENGLANZ" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU SPIEGEL" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU SPOREN" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU STEINGRUBLER" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU STEINERT" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU VORBOURG" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU WINECK-SCHLOSSBERG" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU ZINNKOEPFLE" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU ALTENBERG DE BERGBIETEN" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU ALTENBERG DE WOLXHEIM" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU BRUDERTHAL" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU ENGELBERG" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU FRANKSTEIN" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU KASTELBERG" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU KIRCHBERG DE BARR" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU MOENCHBERG" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU MUENCHBERG" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU PRAELATENBERG" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU STEINKLOTZ" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU WIEBELSBERG" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU WINZENBERG" – "ALSACE GRAND CRU ZOTZENBERG"

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designations

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim one of the controlled designations of origin "Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Bergheim", "Alsace grand cru Brand", "Alsace grand cru Eichberg", "Alsace grand cru Florimont", "Alsace grand cru Froehn", "Alsace grand cru Furstentum", "Alsace grand cru Geisberg", "Alsace grand cru Gloeckelberg", "Alsace grand cru Goldert", "Alsace grand cru Hatschbourg", "Alsace grand cru Hengst", "Alsace grand cru Kaefferkopf", "Alsace grand cru Kanzlerberg", "Alsace grand cru Kessler", "Alsace grand cru Kirchberg de Ribeauvillé", "Alsace grand cru Kitterlé", "Alsace grand cru Mambourg", "Alsace grand cru Mandelberg", "Alsace grand cru Marckrain", "Alsace grand cru Ollwiller", "Alsace grand cru Osterberg", "Alsace grand cru Pfersigberg", "Alsace grand cru Pfingstberg", "Alsace grand cru Rangen", "Alsace grand cru Rosacker", "Alsace grand cru Saering", "Alsace grand cru Schlossberg", "Alsace grand cru Schoenenbourg", "Alsace grand cru Sommerberg", "Alsace grand cru Sonnenglanz", "Alsace grand cru Spiegel", "Alsace grand cru Sporen", "Alsace grand cru Steinert", "Alsace grand cru Steingrubler", "Alsace grand cru Vorbourg", "Alsace grand cru Wineck-Schlossberg", "Alsace grand cru Zinnkoepflé", "Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Bergbieten", "Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Wolxheim", "Alsace grand cru Bruderthal", "Alsace grand cru Engelberg", "Alsace grand cru Frankstein", "Alsace grand cru Kastelberg", "Alsace grand cru Kirchberg de Barr", "Alsace grand cru

Moenchberg", "Alsace grand cru Muenchberg", "Alsace grand cru Praelatenberg", "Alsace grand cru Steinklotz", "Alsace grand cru Wiebelsberg", "Alsace grand cru Winzenberg", "Alsace grand cru Zotzenberg", initially recognised by the decrees of 20 November 1975, 23 November 1983, 17 December 1992 and 12 January 2007.

This specification is drawn up in accordance with the provisions of ordinance no. 45-2675 of 2 November 1945 and without prejudice to law no. 72-628 of 5 July 1972.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

1° – The name of the appellation may be supplemented by one of the customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the grape varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned and meet the production conditions set out in the present specification:

DENOMINATION	GRAPE VARIETIES
Gewurztraminer	gewurztraminer Rs
Muscat	muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B
Muscat Ottonel	muscat ottonel B
Pinot gris	pinot gris G
Riesling	riesling B
Sylvaner	sylvaner B
Pinot noir	pinot noir N

2° – The name of the appellation may be supplemented by the terms "vendanges tardives" or "sélection de grains nobles" for wines meeting the production conditions set for these terms in the present specification, with the exception of wines from harvests gathered in the production area of the appellation "Alsace grand cru Kaefferkopf" and coming from the pinot gris G variety. These terms must be supplemented by one of the following customary denominations as defined in 1° above: Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris, Riesling.

III. – Types of product

The controlled designations of origin covered by the present specification, with the exception of the controlled designations of origin "Alsace grand cru Hengst", "Alsace grand cru Kirchberg de Barr" and "Alsace grand cru Vorbourg", are reserved for still white wines.

The controlled designations of origin "Alsace grand cru Hengst", "Alsace grand cru Kirchberg de Barr" and "Alsace grand cru Vorbourg" are reserved for still white and red wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

The geographical area is as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the sessions of the competent national committee of 1 and 2 June 1983, 6 and 7 November 1991, and 8 and 9 March 2006. The perimeter of this area, on the date of approval of the present specification by the competent national committee, encompasses the territory of the following communes on the basis of the official geographic code of the year 2024. The cartographic documents representing the geographical area may be consulted on the INAO website.

The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines are carried out within the territory of the following communes:

- Haut-Rhin department:

Communes included in full: Ammerschwihr, Beblenheim, Bennwihr, Bergheim, Bergholtz, Eguisheim, Gueberschwihr, Guebwiller, Hattstatt, Hunawihr, Ingersheim, Katzenthal, Mittelwihr, Niedermorschwihr, Orschwihr, Pfaffenheim, Ribeauvillé, Riquewihr, Rodern, Rouffach, Saint-Hippolyte, Soultzmatt, Thann, Turckheim, Vieux-Thann, Voegtlinshoffen, Westhalten, Wettolsheim, Wintzenheim, Wuenheim, Zellenberg.

Commune included in part: Kaysersberg Vignoble, for the territory of the delegated communes of Kientzheim and Sigolsheim only.

- Bas-Rhin department: Andlau, Barr, Bergbieten, Blienschwiller, Dahlenheim, Dambach-la-Ville, Eichhoffen, Kintzheim, Marlenheim, Mittelbergheim, Molsheim, Nothalten, Scharrachbergheim-Irmstett, Wolxheim.

A cartographic document defining the limits of the geographical area is lodged at the town hall for the commune included in part.

2° – Delimited parcel area

The wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the sessions of the competent national committee of 1 and 2 June 1983, 6 and 7 November 1991, 22 and 23 May 2003, 8 and 9 March 2006, 6 and 7 September 2006, 24 January 2007, 11 September 2014 and 25 June 2024, for the following communes.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production areas thus approved.

NAME OF THE APPELLATION	**COMMUNES**
Haut-Rhin department	
Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Bergheim	Bergheim
Alsace grand cru Brand	Turckheim
Alsace grand cru Eichberg	Eguisheim
Alsace grand cru Florimont	Ingersheim and Katzenthal
Alsace grand cru Froehn	Zellenberg
Alsace grand cru Furstentum	Kaysersberg Vignoble
Alsace grand cru Geisberg	Ribeauvillé
Alsace grand cru Gloeckelberg	Rodern and Saint-Hippolyte
Alsace grand cru Goldert	Gueberschwihr
Alsace grand cru Hatschbourg	Hattstatt and Voegtlinshoffen
Alsace grand cru Hengst	Wintzenheim
Alsace grand cru Kaefferkopf	Ammerschwihr
Alsace grand cru Kanzlerberg	Bergheim
Alsace grand cru Kessler	Guebwiller
Alsace grand cru Kirchberg de Ribeauvillé	Ribeauvillé
Alsace grand cru Kitterlé	Guebwiller

NAME OF THE APPELLATION	**COMMUNES**
Alsace grand cru Mambourg	Kaysersberg Vignoble
Alsace grand cru Mandelberg	Mittelwihr and Beblenheim
Alsace grand cru Marckrain	Bennwihr and Kaysersberg Vignoble
Alsace grand cru Ollwiller	Wuenheim
Alsace grand cru Osterberg	Ribeauvillé
Alsace grand cru Pfersigberg	Eguisheim and Wettolsheim
Alsace grand cru Pfingstberg	Orschwihr
Alsace grand cru Rangen	Thann and Vieux-Thann
Alsace grand cru Rosacker	Hunawihr
Alsace grand cru Saering	Guebwiller
Alsace grand cru Schlossberg	Kaysersberg Vignoble
Alsace grand cru Schoenenbourg	Riquewihr and Zellenberg
Alsace grand cru Sommerberg	Niedermorschwihr and Katzenthal
Alsace grand cru Sonnenglanz	Beblenheim
Alsace grand cru Spiegel	Bergholtz and Guebwiller
Alsace grand cru Sporen	Riquewihr
Alsace grand cru Steingrubler	Wettolsheim
Alsace grand cru Steinert	Pfaffenheim and Westhalten
Alsace grand cru Vorbourg	Rouffach and Westhalten
Alsace grand cru Wineck-Schlossberg	Katzenthal and Ammerschwihr
Alsace grand cru Zinnkoepflé	Soultzmatt and Westhalten
Bas-Rhin department	
Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Bergbieten	Bergbieten
Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Wolxheim	Wolxheim
Alsace grand cru Bruderthal	Molsheim
Alsace grand cru Engelberg	Dahlenheim and Scharrachbergheim-Irmstett
Alsace grand cru Frankstein	Dambach-la-Ville
Alsace grand cru Kastelberg	Andlau
Alsace grand cru Kirchberg de Barr	Barr
Alsace grand cru Moenchberg	Andlau and Eichhoffen
Alsace grand cru Muenchberg	Nothalten
Alsace grand cru Praelatenberg	Kintzheim
Alsace grand cru Steinklotz	Marlenheim
Alsace grand cru Wiebelsberg	Andlau
Alsace grand cru Winzenberg	Blienschwiller

NAME OF THE APPELLATION	COMMUNES
Alsace grand cru Zotzenberg	Mittelbergheim

3° – Immediate proximity area

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines, is made up of the territory of the following communes on the basis of the official geographic code of the year 2024:

- Haut-Rhin department:

Communes included in full: Bergholtz-Zell, Berrwiller, Buhl, Cernay, Colmar, Gundolsheim, Hartmanswiller, Herrlisheim, Houssen, Husseren-les-Châteaux, Jungholtz, Leimbach, Obermorschwihr, Osenbach, Ostheim, Rorschwihr, Soultz, Steinbach, Uffholtz, Walbach, Wattwiller, Wihr-au-Val, Zimmerbach.

Commune included in part: Kaysersberg Vignoble, for the territory of the delegated commune of Kaysersberg only.

- Bas-Rhin department:

Communes included in full: Albé, Avolsheim, Balbronn, Bernardswiller, Bernardvillé, Bischoffsheim, Boersch, Bourgheim, Châtenois, Cleebourg, Dachstein, Dangolsheim, Dieffenthal, Dorlisheim, Epfig, Ergersheim, Ernolsheim-Bruche, Fessenheim-le-Bas, Flexbourg, Furdenheim, Gertwiller, Gimbrett (associated commune, attached to Berstett), Goxwiller, Heiligenstein, Itterswiller, Kienheim, Kirchheim, Kuttolsheim, Mutzig, Nordheim, Oberhoffen-lès-Wissembourg, Obernai, Odratzheim, Orschwiller, Osthoffen, Ottrott, Petersbach, Reichsfeld, Riedseltz, Rosenwiller, Rosheim, Rott, Saint-Nabor, Saint-Pierre, Scherwiller, Seebach, Soultz-les-Bains, Steinseltz, Stotzheim, Strasbourg, Traenheim, Villé, Wangen, Westhoffen, Wissembourg, Zellwiller.

Commune included in part: Wingersheim les Quatre Bans (for the territory of the delegated commune of Mittelhausen only).

V. – Grape varieties

1° – Grape varieties

a) – The wines come:

- for white wines:

  − either from a single one of the following varieties: gewurztraminer Rs, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B, pinot gris G, riesling B;

  − or from a blend of the following varieties: muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B;

- for red wines: from the pinot noir N variety.

b) – Wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Bergheim” come:

- either from a single one of the following varieties: gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, riesling B;

- or from a blend of the following varieties:

  − main variety: riesling B;

  − complementary varieties: gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G;

− accessory varieties: for vines planted before 26 March 2005, chasselas B, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B, pinot blanc B, pinot noir N.

c) – Wines of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Zotzenberg" come from a single one of the following varieties: gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, riesling B, sylvaner B.

d) – Wines of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Kaefferkopf" come:

- either from a single one of the following varieties: gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, riesling B;

- or from a blend of the following varieties:

− main variety: gewurztraminer Rs;

− complementary variety: riesling B;

− accessory varieties: muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B, pinot gris G.

e) – Wines liable to benefit from the terms "vendanges tardives" or "sélection de grains nobles" come from the following varieties: gewurztraminer Rs, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B, pinot gris G, riesling B.

2° – Proportion rules on the holding

a) – For wines made from several varieties and liable to benefit from the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Bergheim", the proportion of the riesling B variety may not be less than 50 % nor more than 70 % of the planting.

The proportion of each of the complementary varieties may not be less than 10 % nor more than 25 % of the planting.

The proportion of all the accessory varieties together may not exceed 10 % of the planting.

Compliance of the planting is assessed over all the parcels of the holding producing the wine of the appellation.

b) – For wines made from several varieties and liable to benefit from the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Kaefferkopf", the proportion of the gewurztraminer Rs variety may not be less than 60 % nor more than 80 % of the planting.

The proportion of the riesling B variety may not be less than 10 % nor more than 40 % of the planting.

The proportion of the pinot gris G variety may not exceed 30 % of the planting.

The proportion of the varieties muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs and muscat ottonel B may not exceed 10 % of the planting.

Compliance of the planting is assessed over all the parcels of the holding producing the wine of the appellation, or in relation to all the parcels used to elaborate a multi-variety blended cuvée of this appellation.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density

- For the production of white wine:

The vines have a minimum planting density of 4,500 plants per hectare.

Vines intended for the production of wines liable to benefit from the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Bergheim" and planted from 26 March 2005 have a minimum planting density of 5,500 plants per hectare.

- For the production of red wine:

Vines intended for the production of red wines liable to benefit from the controlled designations of origin "Alsace grand cru Hengst" or "Alsace grand cru Vorbourg" have a minimum planting density of 5,500 plants per hectare.

Vines intended for the production of red wines liable to benefit from the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Kirchberg de Barr" have a minimum planting density of 5,000 plants per hectare.

- Whatever the type of wine:

The vines may not have a spacing between rows greater than 2 metres.

The vines have a spacing within the row of between 0.75 metre minimum and 1.50 metres maximum.

From 25 October 2011, the grubbing-up of rows within a parcel may not result in a spacing between the widest rows greater than 3 metres.

b) – Pruning rules

For white wines, the vines are pruned by single or double Guyot pruning with a maximum of 18 free eyes per plant.

For red wines, the vines are pruned by single or double Guyot pruning with a maximum of 14 free eyes per plant.

c) – Trellising and foliage height rules

The foliage is trained on a vertical trellis. The height of trellised foliage may not be less than 0.675 times the spacing between rows. This height is measured between the attachment wire and the upper limit of the foliage after trimming.

The distance between the carrying wire and the attachment wire may not exceed 0.30 metre.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel

For white wines, the average maximum load per parcel is set at 8,500 kilograms per hectare.

For red wines, the average maximum load per parcel is set at 7,000 kilograms per hectare.

e) – Threshold of missing vines

The percentage of dead or missing vine plants referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at 20 %.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine

The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

2° – Other cultivation practices

a) – In order to preserve the characteristics of the soils, which constitute a fundamental element of the terroir:

- Headlands wider than one metre are grassed, with the exception of vines that cannot be mechanised, known locally as "Kammerle".

- Partial or total covering of the soil and of the vines with sheeting is prohibited.

b) – Vine plantings and replantings are carried out with plant material all of whose components are produced in protected zones or have undergone hot-water treatment as defined by the order in force relating to the control of flavescence dorée.

3° – Irrigation

Irrigation is prohibited.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

a) – The wines come from grapes harvested at good ripeness.

The date of the start of the harvest is set in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-6 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code and of Article 2 of ordinance no. 45-2675 of 2 November 1945 on the definition of the designations of origin of the wines of Alsace.

b) – The wines come from grapes harvested by hand.

c) – Containers used for transporting the harvest must be sheltered from bad weather.

Washing of the harvest containers after each emptying is compulsory.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

a) – The sugar content of the grapes and the natural alcoholic strengths by volume of the wines meet the following characteristics:

APPELLATION, GRAPE VARIETIES	**Minimum sugar content of the grapes (grams per litre of must)**	**Minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume**
Appellations covered by the present specification except the AOCs "Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Bergheim", "Alsace grand cru Kaefferkopf", "Alsace grand cru Hengst", "Alsace grand cru Kirchberg de Barr" and "Alsace grand cru Vorbourg"		
gewurztraminer Rs and pinot gris G	195	12.5 %
Other varieties	170	11 %
AOC "Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Bergheim"		
gewurztraminer Rs and pinot gris G	221	14 %
Riesling	187	12 %
Other varieties	187	-
Wine from a blend of varieties	-	14 %
AOC "Alsace grand cru Kaefferkopf"		
gewurztraminer Rs and pinot gris G	195	12.5 %
Other varieties	170	11 %
Wine from a blend of varieties	-	12 %
"Alsace grand cru Hengst", "Alsace grand cru Vorbourg"		

APPELLATION, GRAPE VARIETIES	**Minimum sugar content of the grapes (grams per litre of must)**	**Minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume**
gewurztraminer Rs and pinot gris G	195	12.5 %
Other varieties	170	11 %
pinot noir N	216	12.5 %
“Alsace grand cru Kirchberg de Barr”		
gewurztraminer Rs and pinot gris G	195	12.5 %
Other varieties	170	11 %
pinot noir N	207	12 %

b) – The sugar content of the grapes and the natural alcoholic strengths by volume of the wines intended for the production of wines liable to benefit from one of the terms “vendanges tardives” or “sélection de grains nobles” meet the following characteristics:

GRAPE VARIETIES	**“Vendanges tardives”: MINIMUM SUGAR CONTENT OF THE GRAPES (g/l of must)**	**“Vendanges tardives”: MINIMUM NATURAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME**	**“Sélection de grains nobles”: MINIMUM SUGAR CONTENT OF THE GRAPES (g/l of must)**	**“Sélection de grains nobles”: MINIMUM NATURAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME**
gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G	270	16 %	306	18.2 %
muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B, riesling B	244	14.5 %	276	16.4 %

c) – Minimum actual alcoholic strength by volume

No particular provision.

VIII. – Yields – Entry into production

1° – Yield

The yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set, for any variety of an appellation covered by the present specification, in hectolitres per hectare, at:

Appellations referred to in article I	
White wines	50
Red wines	40
Appellations referred to in article I supplemented by the term “vendanges tardives”	
White wines	50

Appellations referred to in article I supplemented by the term "sélection de grains nobles"	
White wines	40

2° – Limit yield

The limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set, for any variety of an appellation covered by the present specification, in hectolitres per hectare, at:

Appellations referred to in article I	
White wines	60
Red wines	48
Appellations referred to in article I supplemented by the term "vendanges tardives"	
White wines	60
Appellations referred to in article I supplemented by the term "sélection de grains nobles"	
White wines	48

3° – Maximum production yield

A maximum production yield is set, for any variety of an appellation covered by the present specification, at 77 hectolitres per hectare. This yield corresponds to the total production of the parcels claimed, including that delivered for industrial uses provided for in Article D. 645-14 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

4° – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may only be granted to wines coming from:

- parcels of young vines only from the 3rd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July;

- parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July;

- parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 1st year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the planting of each parcel concerned.

Appellations referred to in article I supplemented by the terms "vendanges tardives" or "sélection de grains nobles"

- parcels of young vines only from the 9th year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July;

- parcels of young vines only from the 8th year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July;

- parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 1st year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the planting of each parcel concerned.

5° – Particular provisions

No additional particular provision.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

a) – Reception and pressing

The installation for receiving and pressing the harvest is sheltered from all kinds of bad weather, as is the press while it is in operation.

The floor of the reception and pressing premises must be easy to clean (nature of the floor, water point, drainage…).

Daily washing of the press is compulsory.

b) – Blending of varieties

The presence of grapes from the varieties gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G and riesling B is compulsory in blended wines liable to benefit from the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Bergheim”. The blending of the grapes is carried out at the pressing stage.

c) – Malolactic fermentation

Malolactic fermentation is completed for red wines.

At the packaging stage, red wines have a malic acid content less than or equal to 0.4 gram per litre.

d) – Analytical standards

Red wines have, after fermentation, a fermentable sugar content (glucose and fructose) less than or equal to 2 grams per litre.

e) – Oenological practices and physical treatments

- The use of pieces of wood is prohibited.

- Wines liable to benefit from the terms “vendanges tardives” or “sélection de grains nobles” are not enriched in any way.

- The increase in the minimum average natural alcoholic strength by volume may not exceed 0.5 % vol. for wines from the gewurztraminer and pinot gris G varieties, and 1.5 % vol. for wines from the other varieties and for wines from a blend of varieties for the appellation “Alsace grand cru Kaefferkopf”.

- For the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Bergheim”, the wines are not enriched in any way.

- Red wines are not enriched in any way.

- After enrichment, the wines do not exceed the following total alcoholic strength by volume:

APPELLATION, CUSTOMARY DENOMINATIONS	**TOTAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME**
Appellations covered by the present specification except the AOCs “Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Bergheim”, “Alsace grand cru Kaefferkopf” and “Alsace grand cru Zotzenberg”	
Muscat Ottonel or Muscat	14 %

APPELLATION, CUSTOMARY DENOMINATIONS	**TOTAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME**
Riesling	14 %
Gewurztraminer	15 %
Pinot gris	15 %
AOC "Alsace grand cru Zotzenberg" supplemented by the customary denomination	
Riesling	14 %
Gewurztraminer	15 %
Pinot gris	15 %
Sylvaner	14 %
AOC "Alsace grand cru Kaefferkopf" supplemented by the customary denomination	
(blended wines)	15 %
Riesling	14 %
Gewurztraminer	15 %
Pinot gris	15 %

f) – Prohibited equipment

- Continuous presses are prohibited.

- Centrifugal pumps for the transfer of the harvest are prohibited.

g) – Vinification and storage vat capacity

Every operator must have a vinification vat capacity equivalent to at least 1.2 times the volume of the previous harvest.

h) – Upkeep of the cellar and equipment

The cellar (floors and walls) and the vinification equipment are in a good general state of upkeep.

2° – Provisions by type of product

- White and red wines are aged at least until 1 November of the year following that of the harvest.

- Wines liable to benefit from the terms "vendanges tardives" or "sélection de grains nobles" are aged at least until 1 June of the second year following that of the harvest.

3° – Provisions relating to packaging

a) – Wines benefiting from the controlled designations of origin covered by the present specification are packaged in bottles of the "Vin du Rhin" type meeting the provisions of European regulations and of decree no. 55-673 of 20 May 1955, the order of 13 May 1959 and the decree of 19 March 1963, or in bottles with the following characteristics:

For 300 cl containers: straight glass body, cylindrical in appearance, topped by a neck with an elongated profile, whose ratios do not exceed:

- Total height / base diameter: between 4.3 and 5.0
- Total height / height of the cylindrical part: between 2.4 and 3.1

For 150 cl containers: straight glass body, cylindrical in appearance, topped by a neck with an elongated profile, whose ratios do not exceed:

- Total height / base diameter: between 4.8 and 5.2
- Total height / height of the cylindrical part: between 2.1 and 3.1

For 100 cl containers: straight glass body, cylindrical in appearance, topped by a neck with an elongated profile, whose ratios do not exceed:

- Total height / base diameter: between 3.6 and 5.0
- Total height / height of the cylindrical part: between 2.1 and 3.1

For 75 cl containers: straight glass body, cylindrical in appearance, topped by a neck with an elongated profile, whose ratios do not exceed:

- Total height / base diameter: between 3.8 and 5.1
- Total height / height of the cylindrical part: between 2.8 and 5.0

For 50 cl containers: straight glass body, cylindrical in appearance, topped by a neck with an elongated profile, whose ratios do not exceed:

- Total height / base diameter: between 4.3 and 5.1
- Total height / height of the cylindrical part: between 2.5 and 4.2

For 37.5 cl containers: straight glass body, cylindrical in appearance, topped by a neck with an elongated profile, whose ratios do not exceed:

- Total height / base diameter: between 4.3 and 5.1
- Total height / height of the cylindrical part: between 2.5 and 5.2

For containers of less than 37.5 cl: straight body, cylindrical in appearance, topped by a neck with an elongated profile, whose ratios do not exceed:

- Total height / base diameter: between 3.3 and 4.4
- Total height / height of the cylindrical part: between 2.6 and 3.0

b) – For every packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body:

- the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code;

- an analysis carried out before or after packaging.

The analysis reports must be kept for a period of 6 months from the date of packaging.

4° – Provisions relating to storage

The operator provides evidence of an appropriate, closed and covered place for the storage of packaged products.

5° – Provisions relating to the circulation of products and placing on the market for the consumer

a) – Date of placing on the market for the consumer

- At the end of the ageing period, white and red wines may only be placed on the market for the consumer from 1 November of the year following that of the harvest.

- At the end of the ageing period, wines benefiting from the terms “vendanges tardives” or “sélection de grains nobles” are placed on the market for the consumer from 1 June of the 2nd year following that of the harvest.

b) – Period during which musts, partially fermented musts and wines may not circulate between authorised warehousekeepers

Musts, partially fermented musts and wines may circulate between authorised warehousekeepers at the earliest on 1 December of the year of harvest.

X. – Link with the geographical area

“Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Bergheim”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Bergheim” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

Located entirely in the commune of Bergheim, at the outlet of the small closed valley of the Bergenbach, the Altenberg de Bergheim grand cru is a majestic, warm and sunny terroir, facing mainly south yet never short of water, with a moderate to steep slope.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the Grasberg hill. The landscape is completely open, without screening.

This terroir, detached from the Vosges massif and marked by a certain surface diversity of soils, is very particular. The clay-limestone-sandstone geological nature of the terroir gives red, calcareous, fine and stony soils, rich in marls and highly prone to erosion. There is a tendency to chlorosis, and humus is not a central issue.

In climatic terms, this appellation is protected from north winds by the relief of the Altenberg and from west winds by the Taennchel massif. Rainfall is low. The mesoclimate is calm and still; there is no wind. Consequently, the difference between day and night temperatures is small; this absence of jolts means that physiological ripening advances gently: the grapes are harvested late, often at a time when noble rot is beginning to develop.

The parcels are fairly large, planted in the direction of the slope, at high planting density and of rather advanced age. The vineyard shows good vigour and low but regular productivity. A terroir that is regular in terms of yield, physiological ripeness and degree, regularly capable of great ripeness, the Altenberg de Bergheim is marked by a complex mix of varieties, ripened and harvested at the same time.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: “the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers’ syndicates.”

Indeed, the Altenberg de Bergheim is cited in the oldest chronicles, bequests and religious properties. It long belonged to the Cistercian order and then to the powerful Ribeaupierre family. The work by

Médard Barth, “Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine”, written in 1958, praises this lieu-dit, recognised today.

As a modern translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Bergheim” was recognised in 1983. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The varieties selected are mainly the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G. Other varieties may enter into the composition of a blended wine bearing the name of the terroir.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the “Vin du Rhin”-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”. The minimum planting density is 5,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, the wines of the appellation “Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Bergheim” are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to excellent ripeness of the grapes. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time. Young wines are discreet on the attack, voluminous on the palate and with a fruity acidity. Originality is expressed very well in the blended wines.

The Altenberg de Bergheim produces wines powerfully marked by the terroir because the grapes harvested are thin-skinned, physiologically ripe, sensitive to the weather and of high degree: the musts are never enriched. These wines show a seasonal evolution and very high ageing potential, and reach their peak after 15 to 20 years. These original characteristics are linked to the natural factors of the terroir and to the practices of the wine-growers detailed here.

At their peak these wines are very powerful, discreet on the attack, voluminous on the palate, with a fruity, vanilla-tinged and gentle acidity, often marked by noble rot yet remaining very mouth-watering.

Four types of product can be distinguished:

- the identity group, by far the largest, made up of aromatic, rich, fruity, full and complex wines from the authorised varieties, planted alone or mixed as permitted by the specification, wines that are never technically dry;

- a group from the riesling variety alone, characterised by drier, mineral, deep wines, sometimes marked by fossil aromas.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish;

- wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are

systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Bergheim" expresses the quintessence of a very great terroir. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, this vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The location, the general full-south orientation, the slope, the geology and particularly the highly fractured limestone subsoils, the strength of the shallow clay-limestone soils, the warm climate and the regular water supply give the vine the possibility of regular growth, balanced vigour and production of extreme quality.

Rather late-ripening, the terroir leads to high levels of ripeness, often amplified by the excellent late-season climatic conditions favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allowing the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. The "Altenberg de Bergheim" wines include some of the most highly valued wines produced in Alsace.

"Alsace grand cru Brand"

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Brand" forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Brand" is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

Exposed to winds (föhn) owing to its situation at the entrance to a valley, the grand cru enjoys abundant sunshine. The Brand grand cru is a warm, early-ripening terroir. The fractured granite, a rock made up of quartz, feldspar and two micas, known as "Turckheim granite", gives the "Brand" a unique identity. The sandy, coarse texture of the soil and its stoniness favour deep rooting of the vine and ensure good drainage.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Brand” was recognised in 1983. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the “Vin du Rhin”-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”. The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Brand” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The fineness of the granitic soils and the föhn make the wines aromatic, of great power and intensity. The silica gives this expression of fine, straight acidity (“steinglitz”). A sometimes peppery note, a mouth-watering palate, structural bitterness.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The work by Médard Barth, "Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine", written in 1958, already praises this lieu-dit, recognised today.

"Alsace grand cru Eichberg"

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Eichberg" forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Eichberg" is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

The substratum of this grand cru is essentially made up of calcareous conglomerates and marls, overlain at the foot of the slope by colluvium of the same nature, which may however incorporate sandstone scree and pebbles. The scree does not rest directly on the coastal conglomerate but is separated from it by a layer of yellow clay of variable thickness. The soil is thus sometimes siliceous, fairly clayey and rich in gravel.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Eichberg" was recognised in 1983. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Eichberg” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

Reflecting the pedo-geological situation of the grand cru, the wines, of great minerality, show a lively acidity complemented by fruity and floral aromas. Austere in their youth, they are of great longevity with a remarkable ageing capacity.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

“Alsace grand cru Florimont”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Florimont” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Florimont" is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

Situated on an advanced knoll of the sub-Vosgian hills, this grand cru benefits from a warm, dry mesoclimate favourable to early ripening of the grapes. The substratum is characterised by Bathonian and Bajocian limestone rocks, covered lower down the slope by Oligocene conglomerates and marls, and gives relatively stony marl-limestone soils.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Florimont" was recognised in 1992. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term "vendanges tardives" often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Florimont” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

Its climatic characteristics and the strength of its calcareous marls make the Florimont an early-ripening, warm grand cru that gives powerful wines of great finesse. Their acidity provides structure.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

“Alsace grand cru Froehn”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Froehn” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment here. The Froehn is a terroir unique of its kind, since it spreads over 180°, from south-west to east, at the foot of the small medieval village of Zellenberg (“cell on the mountain”). The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Froehn” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

The grand cru is well ventilated, with significant temperature variations in spring and autumn. Situated right in a fault zone, its geology is predominantly calcareous (marls, sandy limestone, carbonated sandstone), giving rich, deep soils that do not suffer from drought. These types of soil, combined with the climate, allow early and even ripening of the grapes.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording:

"the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Froehn" was recognised in 1992. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines: often golden yellow with green highlights, they have a charming fruitiness while provoking strong salivation, marked by a long and complex acidity;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines: often of high ripeness and golden in colour, they frequently prove rich in sugar while retaining an airy, digestible character;

- wines benefiting from the term "vendanges tardives" often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish;

- wines benefiting from the term "sélection de grains nobles" are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Froehn" exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The calcareous dominance and the depth of the soils give aromatic, fruity, rich and complex wines with the same expression of acidity followed by a significant minerality that increases with ageing, whatever the level of sweetness. The Liassic marls over ferruginous sandy limestones, which are the

particular feature of the Froehn grand cru, give breadth and generosity to the wines in their youth and minerality as they age. The attack is tight and centred, then opens up with amplitude, its substance enveloping the acidity. The powerful character of the marls gives a powerful, enveloping structure to the rich wines, accompanied by a slight bitterness that supports the length of the wine. Wines of great ripeness take a long time to open up. Full of subtlety, their palates are often marked by a fine salinity.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The work by Médard Barth, “Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine”, written in 1958, already praises this lieu-dit, recognised today.

“Alsace grand cru Furstentum”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Furstentum” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Furstentum” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

Its amphitheatre-like situation protects this lieu-dit from the winds. The marl-limestone-sandstone soils accumulate heat, creating a Mediterranean-type mesoclimate.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: “the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers’ syndicates.”

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Furstentum” was recognised in 1992. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the “Vin du Rhin”-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”. The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Furstentum” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The protected situation of the grand cru and the type of soil give the wines a great aromatic diversity with spicy and floral notes, before allowing more mineral touches to come through. The citrus-type acidity is accompanied by a tannic structure that gives the wines their great ageing potential.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

“Alsace grand cru Geisberg”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Geisberg” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed, steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Geisberg” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

Perfectly homogeneous geologically, the grand cru stems from a substratum formed essentially of dolomites and dolomitic marls, overlain by variegated sandy marls with gypsum at the top. The soils are clayey and stony. The vineyard is situated on steep slopes, magnificently exposed to the sun (full south) and marked by the presence of numerous low walls. The cool night winds (“Tahlwendala”) coming out of the valley bring cool summer temperatures that allow slow ripening of the harvest.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: “the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers’ syndicates.”

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Geisberg” was recognised in 1983. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the “Vin du Rhin”-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”. The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Geisberg” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The pedological characteristics linked to the situation at the mouth of the valley favour the salinity and the acid backbone of the wines, leading to balanced, racy wines that are long on the palate and bring great finesse. The years bring them minerality and complexity.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The work by Médard Barth, “Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine”, written in 1958, already praises this lieu-dit, recognised today.

“Alsace grand cru Gloeckelberg”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Gloeckelberg” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Gloeckelberg” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

Within a narrow, closed valley and on acid brown soils that are coarse, sandy and naturally free-draining, sometimes more clayey, the grand cru combines conditions conducive to early ripening, favoured by the rapid warming of the soils and its position sheltered from the winds.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Gloeckelberg" was recognised in 1983. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term "vendanges tardives" often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term "sélection de grains nobles" are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Gloeckelberg" exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The early ripening conditions mean that the wines are ample, rich and complex, made from overripe and sometimes botrytised grapes. The fine harmony between sugars and acids, which asserts itself over time, should be emphasised.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

“Alsace grand cru Goldert”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Goldert” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Goldert” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

The geological substratum consists of oolitic limestone in the upper part, and of conglomerates covered by soliflucted Quaternary deposits in the lower part of the slope, where debris of limestone and sandstone is embedded in a clay matrix. The nature of the soil, which ensures good drainage, combined with the mesoclimate, preserves the sanitary condition of the grapes late into the season.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: “the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers’ syndicates.”

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Goldert” was recognised in 1983. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the “Vin du Rhin”-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”. The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from

the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Three types of wine can be distinguished:

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines. These types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish;

- wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Goldert” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The mesoclimate allows the wines to be built on a structuring acidity. They are fruity, rich, voluminous and complex.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

“Alsace grand cru Hatschbourg”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Hatschbourg” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides

of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Hatschbourg" is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

Situated on a hillside, the grand cru rests on a soil with a marl-limestone substratum containing abundant gravel, which ensures excellent drainage.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Hatschbourg" was recognised in 1983. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term "vendanges tardives" often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term "sélection de grains nobles" are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" are

systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Hatschbourg" exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The rich, free-draining soils give the wines an aromatic, fruity character. They are full-bodied, rich, complex and opulent, with good ageing potential.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

"Alsace grand cru Hengst"

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Hengst" forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Hengst" is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

The grand cru is established on a slender ridge in the commune of Wintzenheim. The deep, stony soil consists essentially of Oligocene conglomerates and calcareous marls.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Hengst" was recognised in 1983 for white wines and then in 2022 for red wines. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. For white wines, the only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination. For red wines, only pinot noir N is authorised.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the “Vin du Rhin”-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”. The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare for the production of white wine and 5,500 plants per hectare for the production of red wine. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months. The red wines, for their part, are not enriched in any way. They must undergo a minimum ageing period of 11 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

The white wines:

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

The red wines:

The red wines are characterised by their power and depth; they are racy and of very long keeping. With a fine ruby-red colour, the wines stand out on the nose for their complexity, with notes of red fruit and spices. On the palate their texture is rich and elegant, with silky tannins. Of great structure, the red wines of the “Hengst” grand cru have a long, fine finish and gain in expression over time.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Hengst” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The soil and climate situation gives the wines a solid, well-built character, conducive to ageing. The wines are powerful, complex and dense, with a finish marked by a ripe acidity. This marl-limestone

terroir, combined with a unique microclimate, allows perfect ripeness of the grapes, giving racy red wines with silky tannins.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The work by Médard Barth, "Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine", written in 1958, already praises this lieu-dit, recognised today.

"Alsace grand cru Kaefferkopf"

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Kaefferkopf" forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Kaefferkopf" is characterised by soils associated with a most favourable mesoclimate. Facing south-east and established on the six hills ("Kopf") overlooking the commune of Ammerschwihr, the lieu-dit is cool, with slow ripening of the grapes. The brown soils, derived from various parent rocks, are mostly deep and saturated in calcium and magnesium.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

The name Kaefferkopf appears in 1338 in the land register (urbarium) of the abbey of Pairis. Several works and theses cite it during the 19th and 20th centuries. In 1932, the Kaefferkopf was the first lieu-dit to be recognised by a judicial delimitation. The Confrérie des Amis d'Ammerschwihr et du Kaefferkopf, which holds a large wine library, has ensured its renown since 1984.

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Kaefferkopf" was recognised in 2007. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G and, as accessory varieties, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. The historical usage of the Kaefferkopf is a harmonious blend of the different varieties selected. They may also be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the “Vin du Rhin”-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”. The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the name of one of the complementary denominations, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Kaefferkopf” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

Protection from cold winds and from excessive sun exposure, owing to its unique situation, and the saturation of its soils in calcium and magnesium give powerful, well-structured, complex and rich wines with a fine freshness on the palate. These characters, particularly perceptible in the blended wines, express themselves remarkably after a few years of ageing. The wines then give way to a strong personality underlined by fine aromatic and saline length.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The work by Médard Barth, “Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine”, written in 1958, already praises this lieu-dit, recognised today.

“Alsace grand cru Kanzlerberg”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Kanzlerberg” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Kanzlerberg” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

The grand cru is situated at the edge of the closed valley of the Bergenbach and protected to the west by the Taennchel massif. Rainfall is low. The fairly steep slopes of the Kanzlerberg, at the foot of which flows the Bergenbach stream, face south and south-west. They become gentler in the upper part, forming a small plateau on the southern side at an average altitude of 250 metres. The grey marl-limestone soil is strongly marked by its particular composition of grey and black Keuper marls with gypsum, over a rock of silicified limestone made up of crystals of fluorite and baryte, the finest in Alsace. These characteristics make it a late-ripening lieu-dit with a long ripening period.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: “the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers’ syndicates.”

Historically, the cultivation of the vine is already mentioned here in 1312, the date of the suppression of the Order of the Templars, which at this spot owned the commandery of the Tempelhof. This estate was taken over by the Knights of St John of Jerusalem of the Order of Malta, whence the name of the lieu-dit, “Mont St Jean”. The work by Médard Barth, “Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine”, written in 1958, already praises this lieu-dit, recognised today.

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Kanzlerberg” was recognised in 1983. The Kanzlerberg grand cru has the smallest area (3.40 ha) of the Alsace grands crus. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the “Vin du Rhin”-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”. The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from

the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Kanzlerberg” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The vines of the Kanzlerberg follow the incline of the land, exposing their fruit to the summer heat, tempered by the coolness of the Bergenbach stream and the light breeze from the valley floor. The yield is regular. Physiological ripeness is reached at a minimum degree, and the site is regularly capable of great ripeness. This late situation of the Kanzlerberg grand cru and the exceptional geology of the site – gypsum-bearing marl at the surface over a base of sedimentary rocks with multiple crystals in the subsoil – make the wines very powerful, with a foundational, broad, complex and mineral acidity. They remain discreet and elegant in their youth, and reveal all their complexity and freshness after a few years of ageing.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. These wines, with a unique and very high ageing potential, develop qualitatively over several decades while retaining fine vitality, the energy of the terroir. They constitute the top of the range of this region. The wines of the Kanzlerberg are among the most highly valued wines of the Alsace vineyard.

"Alsace grand cru Kessler"

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Kessler" forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Kessler" is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

The "Kessler", situated on the east-facing flank of the "Unterlinger" hill, forms at its centre an amphitheatre that shelters it from north winds and from the cold air currents brought down by the Guebwiller valley. This grand cru rests on a Vosges sandstone substratum of the Buntsandstein, which has given reddish sandy-clay soils. At its base appears a linear outcrop of shelly limestone (Muschelkalk) covered by sandstone colluvium. The landscape is marked by the cultivation of vines on terraces and a succession of stone walls.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Kessler" was recognised in 1983. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Kessler” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The homogeneity of the substratum allows the different varieties to express all their specific features, with wines that are dry and mineral, marked by liveliness and by floral and fruity aromas that are persistent and harmonious.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The work by Médard Barth, “Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine”, written in 1958, already praises this lieu-dit, recognised today.

“Alsace grand cru Kirchberg de Ribeauvillé”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Kirchberg de Ribeauvillé” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Kirchberg de Ribeauvillé” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

Developed on a substratum made up, lower down, of Triassic dolomitic marls and dolomites of the lower shelly limestone (Muschelkalk) and, higher up, of variegated sandy and gypsiferous marls of the middle shelly limestone (Muschelkalk), the soils are clayey and generally very stony. Despite the very good sunshine and the slope, ripening of the grapes remains late, given the cool night valley winds ("Tahlwendala") coming from the valley behind Ribeauvillé and descending from the Vosges. The relatively long ripening of the grapes occasionally allows noble rot to develop and favours the aromatic complexity of the wines.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Kirchberg de Ribeauvillé" was recognised in 1983. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term "vendanges tardives" often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term "sélection de grains nobles" are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration

and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable mesoclimatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Kirchberg de Ribeauvillé” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a thousand nuances, a marked character and a unique personality.

Marked by strong sunshine and by a slow, long ripening due to the Tahlwendala, the wines are mostly aromatic, balanced, rich and complex on the palate, with fine salinity and marked by a firm acid backbone giving them balance and length. Spicy notes are quite frequently present on the nose. The years bring them minerality and complexity.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The work by Médard Barth, “Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine”, written in 1958, already praises this lieu-dit, recognised today.

“Alsace grand cru Kitterlé”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Kitterlé” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Kitterlé” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

At the outlet of the Lauch valley and north of Guebwiller, the Kitterlé forms a spur on the Unterlinger massif overlooking the Alsace plain. This grand cru offers various exposures: south, south-east and south-west. Its substratum is essentially formed of coarse Vosges sandstone and quartzite conglomerate of the middle Buntsandstein, as well as sandstone-volcanic ground belonging to the Carboniferous greywacke at the western end. The landscape is marked by the cultivation of vines on terraces and a succession of stone walls.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording:

"the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Kitterlé" was recognised in 1983. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term "vendanges tardives" often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term "sélection de grains nobles" are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Kitterlé" exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The sandstone and the very good exposure mark the wines with finesse of aroma and great concentration.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The work by Médard Barth, "Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine", written in 1958, already praises this lieu-dit, recognised today.

"Alsace grand cru Mambourg"

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Mambourg" forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Mambourg" is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

Situated at the outlet of the Kaysersberg valley, on one of the hillsides projecting furthest into the plain, this lieu-dit thus benefits from a mesoclimate marked by small temperature ranges, far from the influence of the Vosges massif and enjoying maximum sunshine. It is one of the earliest-ripening hillsides in Alsace, with the particular feature of a small temperature range. The small parcels, generally planted in the direction of the slope, are interspersed with dry-stone walls. The calcium-magnesium soils, derived from Oligocene calcareous conglomerates and marls, are favourable to deep rooting and not conducive to very high yields. Production is regular and not very sensitive to the vintage effect. Drought risks are very rare.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

The work by Médard Barth, "Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine", written in 1958, already praises this lieu-dit, recognised today. History reveals that the wines of the Mambourg were renowned as early as 783. The first altar wine mentioned in Alsace at that time is said to have come from the Mambourg. The divine character of the terroir indeed appears as early as the Carolingian era, in view of the interest shown in it by churchmen. In the 10th century, seven abbeys, three of them non-Alsatian, claimed possessions in the present-day Mambourg.

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Mambourg" was recognised in 1983. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white

varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines, sometimes tannic.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term "vendanges tardives" often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term "sélection de grains nobles" are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Mambourg" exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The sunny, warm character of the grand cru, the calcareous power of the soils and the regular water supply give the wines power and great expression, with a tannic dimension. These characters need a few years of ageing to find their balance. The wines are then intensely aromatic and marked by notes of ripe fruit and flowers, rich and opulent.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

“Alsace grand cru Mandelberg”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Mandelberg” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Mandelberg” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

The soil is marl-limestone, overlying conglomerates of the Tertiary edge of the Rhine Graben. These conglomerates include dolomite pebbles, enriching the soil with magnesium.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: “the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers’ syndicates.”

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Mandelberg” was recognised in 1992. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the “Vin du Rhin”-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”. The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable mesoclimatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Mandelberg” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a thousand nuances, a marked character and a unique personality.

The wines develop a pronounced fruitiness and great finesse, characteristic of a calcium-magnesium soil. Their ageing potential relies on a rich, full-bodied character.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The work by Médard Barth, “Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine”, written in 1958, already praises this lieu-dit, recognised today.

“Alsace grand cru Marckrain”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Marckrain” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Marckrain” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

This grand cru is situated at the tip of the long promontory bounded by the valleys of Kaysersberg and Riquewihr. Gently sloping, it is subject to a considerable temperature range. The marl-limestone soil is rich in red clay associated with sand and a high proportion of pebbles. This deep soil favours the onset of noble rot.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Marckrain" was recognised in 1992. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term "vendanges tardives" often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term "sélection de grains nobles" are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Marckrain" exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The deep soils, marked by limestone, make it possible to obtain powerful, fruity wines with spicy notes. The marked, ripe acidity contributes to the balance and good keeping of the wines over time.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

"Alsace grand cru Ollwiller"

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Ollwiller" forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Ollwiller" is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

The soils, derived from conglomerates and marls, are sandy-clay to clayey, but much sandier on the colluvium. The texture of the soil is sandy, and the mesoclimate is particularly dry owing to the protection of the Freunstein and the Vieil-Armand (rainfall of 450 mm per year).

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Ollwiller" was recognised in 1983. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”. The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable mesoclimatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Ollwiller” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a thousand nuances, a marked character and a unique personality.

The clayey characteristics of the soil and the low rainfall favour wines with a supple, complex, ample structure and a marked acidity, expressing their fullness after a few years of ageing.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

“Alsace grand cru Osterberg”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Osterberg” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Osterberg” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

The soils are marly and stony, derived from the upper shelly limestone (Muschelkalk), variegated marls and dolomitic limestones. The vineyard is fairly late-ripening as it is under the influence of winds from the Aubure valley. The often long ripening of the grapes allows the presence of noble rot.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: “the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers’ syndicates.”

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Osterberg” was recognised in 1992. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the “Vin du Rhin”-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”. The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Osterberg” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The late situation of the grand cru contributes to obtaining a complex and well-present acidity and salinity. These characteristics make it possible to produce balanced, powerful wines without heaviness. The ageing potential of these wines is remarkable.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The work by Médard Barth, “Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine”, written in 1958, already praises this lieu-dit, recognised today.

“Alsace grand cru Pfersigberg”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Pfersigberg” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Pfersigberg” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

The marl-limestone-sandstone soil consists of a base of hard limestone rock, covered with pebbles of varied nature but predominantly marl-limestone. Sheltered from oceanic influences by the screen of the Vosges and their forests, the grand cru occupies three hillsides. The grapes easily reach great ripeness.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Pfersigberg" was recognised in 1992. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term "vendanges tardives" often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term "sélection de grains nobles" are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable mesoclimatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Pfersigberg" exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a thousand nuances, a marked character and a unique personality.

The homogeneous marl-limestone soils produce rich wines with power and opulence, while retaining the fine acid backbone of their calcareous soil.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

"Alsace grand cru Pfingstberg"

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Pfingstberg" forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Pfingstberg" is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

This grand cru rests on a limestone-sandstone substratum, with a proportion of clay increasing towards its lower part. At its summit the subsoil is dominated by a micaceous sandstone (Buntsandstein) with a limestone-sandstone texture, whereas at the base there is a shelly limestone sandstone (Muschelkalk) with a marl-limestone-sandstone soil texture. The forest at the top of the Pfingstberg guarantees a constant water supply and tempers climatic variations. Its very free-draining sandstone soil thus avoids any excess of water.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Pfingstberg" was recognised in 1992. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from

the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Pfingstberg” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The strength of the limestone expresses itself by giving amplitude to the wines and by developing an aromatic complexity and a power always underlined by a very fine harmony, due to the temperate climate and the sandstone.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

“Alsace grand cru Rangen”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Rangen” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the

controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Rangen” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

The Rangen is the most southerly grand cru of Alsace and is situated at the mouth of a valley in the communes of Thann and Vieux-Thann, covering an area of 22 ha in a single block. Its altitude (350 m to 450 m) and the proximity of the Vosges massif, together with above-average rainfall (850 mm/year), characterise a late climate with slow ripening. A sunny exposure (south-south-west to south), a steep slope (90 % on average), a dark soil colour and the proximity of the river Thur make it possible to obtain high levels of ripeness at the end of the season. A long ripening period gives the wines great complexity.

The particular and unique terroir of the Rangen, of Carboniferous age (Devono-Dinantian), is composed of volcanic-sedimentary rocks. The stones strewn over it come from hard rocks, namely greywackes, volcanic tuffs and a flow rock, a brown micaceous andesite. This layer has a thickness varying between 40 and 60 cm above the fissured parent rock, which allows the roots to penetrate to a considerable depth. The nature of the ground and the depth of the soil characterise a lean environment, poor in clays but of quality, and therefore favourable to obtaining great wines and small natural yields.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: “the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers’ syndicates.”

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Rangen” was recognised in 1983. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the “Vin du Rhin”-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”. The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow / slightly amber old gold.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Rangen” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The volcanic nature of the grand cru, linked to exceptional geographical characteristics, gives the wines their golden colour, their great mineral strength, and an acidity and noble bitterness. They have a long finish and a racy, ripe acidity.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

Going back through history, we observe that the Rangen has been the subject of praise and of numerous mentions in works and writings since the 12th century. In the 16th century, decrees prohibited blending Rangen wines with other wines so that the name Rangen could be kept on the labels. At that same time the town of Thann had a regulation concerning the planting of the Rangen; decrees of 1548 and 1581 contain several paragraphs defining certain production rules.

“Alsace grand cru Rosacker”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Rosacker” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides

of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Rosacker” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

Its proximity to the Vosges massif, against which it rests, gives this grand cru a dry but also cool and shaded mesoclimate. These characters allow slow, regular and healthy ripening of the grapes. The deep shelly limestone (Muschelkalk) soil, poor in potassium, preserves large quantities of tartaric acid.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: “the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers’ syndicates.”

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Rosacker” was recognised in 1983. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the “Vin du Rhin”-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”. The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration

and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Rosacker” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The depth of the soil, linked to the later climate of the Rosacker, gives wines structured by a powerful, ripe acidity (tartaric acid) that gives them great length and freshness. The long, regular and complete ripening of the grapes is a guarantee of finesse and aromatic complexity.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The work by Médard Barth, “Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine”, written in 1958, already praises this lieu-dit, recognised today.

“Alsace grand cru Saering”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Saering” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Saering” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

This grand cru forms a limestone knoll on which conglomerates with Buntsandstein sandstone pebbles and debris of granitic rocks have been deposited. Locally, the limestone subsoil may outcrop. The soil as a whole has a marl-sandy texture, abundantly supplied with gravel.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: “the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers’ syndicates.”

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Saering” was recognised in 1983. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise

delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term "vendanges tardives" often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term "sélection de grains nobles" are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Saering" exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The stony texture and the sandstone explain the pronounced salinity of the wines. The presence of limestone allows more incisive acidities, a guarantee of the longevity of the wines.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and

their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The work by Médard Barth, “Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine”, written in 1958, already praises this lieu-dit, recognised today.

“Alsace grand cru Schlossberg”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Schlossberg” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Schlossberg” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

The grand cru is subject to the ventilation coming from the Kaysersberg valley. The sunny, warm hillside rests on acid soils derived from migmatites and granite, giving great mineral fertility.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: “the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers’ syndicates.”

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Schlossberg” was recognised in 1975. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the “Vin du Rhin”-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”. The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much

complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable mesoclimatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Schlossberg” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a thousand nuances, a marked character and a unique personality.

The regular ventilation of the westerly flow from the valley asserts the aromatic finesse of the wines. The light soils are decisive for the finesse and multiplicity of the wines’ aromas. The wines are airy and rich in floral aromas. They reach their fullness after a few years, then revealing an unmistakable minerality.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The work by Médard Barth, “Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine”, written in 1958, already praises this lieu-dit, recognised today.

“Alsace grand cru Schoenenbourg”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Schoenenbourg” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Schoenenbourg” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

Situated at the outlet of a small, closed and cool valley, this grand cru is remarkably protected from the prevailing west and north winds. Rather late, warming up slowly in spring and ensuring slow, regular ripening of the grapes, the lieu-dit is warm and subject to a large day–night temperature range. Clayey-marly, the soil is deep, rich in Keuper marl and gypsum veins. It contains a greater or lesser proportion of pink sandstone and glacial sands. It is particularly rich in nutrients and retains water well.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: “the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers’ syndicates.”

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Schoenenbourg” was recognised in 1992. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the “Vin du Rhin”-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”. The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Schoenenbourg” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The deep, marly soils give opulent, well-structured, deep and complex wines with great restraint in their youth. The acid structure is particularly remarkable and very original, marked by the gypsum and by fine bitter notes.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

“Alsace grand cru Sommerberg”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Sommerberg” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Sommerberg” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

It lies in the extension of the summit of the Galtz. The very steep slope of the grand cru makes it very sunny. It rests on acid soils derived from granitic sand (arène). Its relief is characterised by a succession of three amphitheatres separated by outcrops of the parent rock. The very stony soil has the effect of storing the heat of the day and releasing it at night. This makes the terroir early in spring, but with fairly slow ripening.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: “the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers’ syndicates.”

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Sommerberg” was recognised in 1983. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the “Vin du Rhin”-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”. The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Sommerberg” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The richness and diversity of the minerals found naturally in the soils determine the finesse and multiplicity of the wines’ aromas. Noble citrus bitterness is often found.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

“Alsace grand cru Sonnenglanz”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Sonnenglanz” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Sonnenglanz” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

Projecting into the plain, on a limestone promontory of Oligocene marls over pebbles, this grand cru is early-ripening and rather dry. These conditions are favourable to high ripeness of the grapes, often associated with the development of noble rot. This calcareous brown soil, relatively heavy, stony and deep, induces a slow start of vegetation linked to the very gradual warming of the soil. The geological nature of the soil ensures excellent retention of water and nutrients while allowing good drainage of rainwater.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: “the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers’ syndicates.”

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Sonnenglanz” was recognised in 1983. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the “Vin du Rhin”-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”. The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be

supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Sonnenglanz” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The warm, dry character of the grand cru gives the wines an acidity that is both firm and tender. At the same time, they are marked by suave, complex and elegant aromas resulting from overripeness, displaying lightness and fluidity. The wines of the Sonnenglanz grand cru evolve very well over time, developing fine mineral aromas on the finish, which gives them a very digestible character.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

“Alsace grand cru Spiegel”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Spiegel” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Spiegel” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

The substratum consists of conglomerates (mostly sandstone pebbles) and interbedded marls of the Lattorfian, partially covered by sandstone colluvium and scree. The soils born of this substratum have a clay-sandy texture guaranteeing slow ripening of the grapes and the preservation of aromatic potential.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: “the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers’ syndicates.”

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Spiegel” was recognised in 1983. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the “Vin du Rhin”-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”. The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration

and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Spiegel” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The marls bring power and the well-structured character of the wine, while the sandstone brings nervousness. The wines of the Spiegel grand cru are characterised by their airy, fresh side, with a fine nervousness that preserves their qualities over time.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The work by Médard Barth, “Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine”, written in 1958, already praises this lieu-dit, recognised today.

“Alsace grand cru Sporen”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Sporen” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Sporen” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

It is a natural, gently sloping cirque. The clay-marl soils of decalcified Lias contain an ideal proportion of sandy sandstone and are particularly rich in phosphoric acid. They are deep and heavy, retaining water, and favour slow, regular and rather late ripening of the grapes.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: “the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers’ syndicates.”

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Sporen” was recognised in 1992. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise

delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term "vendanges tardives" often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term "sélection de grains nobles" are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Sporen" exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The strength of the soils and the late character of the grand cru mean that one finds massive, warm, voluminous and rich wines with an acidity sometimes in the background, compensated by the presence of tannins, and discreet wines with ample, rich structures. They have an excellent aptitude for ageing.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

“Alsace grand cru Steinert”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Steinert” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Steinert” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

The grand cru is a kind of promontory backing onto the Schauenberg, which overlooks it. It consists exclusively of very hard oolitic limestone. The shallow soil contains numerous fragments of the calcareous parent rock, which release the stored heat.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: “the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers’ syndicates.”

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Steinert” was recognised in 1992. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the “Vin du Rhin”-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”. The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much

complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Steinert” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

Combined with a mesoclimate tending to dryness, this whole gives powerful, frank and massive wines with a medium acidity. The aromas are mainly in the fruity-floral register, with spicy and minty notes.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The work by Médard Barth, “Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine”, written in 1958, cites the link between this terroir and the abbey of Muri, cradle of the Habsburg dynasty, as early as 1058.

“Alsace grand cru Steingrubler”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Steingrubler” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Steingrubler” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

The stony marl-limestone to clay-sandy soils are established on marls and conglomerates, partially covered by scree and granitic sand. The upper part of the grand cru is sandy, while the lower part is richer in limestone.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: “the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers’ syndicates.”

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Steingrubler” was recognised in 1992. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the “Vin du Rhin”-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”. The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are

systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Steingrubler" exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

A rather late grand cru owing to the proximity of the Vosges mountains, its wines are characterised by a fresh acidity and aromas of great finesse that gain in expression over time.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The work by Médard Barth, "Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine", written in 1958, already praises this lieu-dit, recognised today.

"Alsace grand cru Vorbourg"

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Vorbourg" forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Vorbourg" is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

The particularly dry and sunny mesoclimate, at the foot of the "Grand Ballon" and the "Petit Ballon", makes it an early lieu-dit with high levels of ripeness. The soils are marl-limestone, with Bajocian oolitic limestones and Oligocene calcareous conglomerates. The presence of a dry, warm wind (föhn) reinforces the high ripeness. Topped by limestone heathland, the lieu-dit has no significant water reserve.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Vorbourg" was recognised in 1992. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise

delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties, although before the German period (before 1870) the vineyards of the commune of Rouffach were better known for their red wines than for their white wines. The reds were more expensive and more appreciated than the whites. The production of high-quality red wines from the pinot noir variety has always persisted. This production, linked to the terroir of the Vorbourg grand cru, was recognised in 2024.

The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination. The pinot noir variety is used solely for the production of red wines. For red wines, enrichment is prohibited. These wines are marketed after a minimum ageing period of 11 months.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare, and 5,500 plants per hectare for pinot noir. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

The white wines:

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

The white wines of the Vorbourg are ample and massive, with a fine minerality and a marked salinity. Their finish is tannic. Fruit aromas (citrus, white peach, pear…) dominate. The ripe acidity forms the backbone of the wine. The colour is of sustained intensity, ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term "vendanges tardives" often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term "sélection de grains nobles" are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

The red wines:

The colour of the red wines is deep and bright. Aromas of small red and black fruits mingle with mineral notes. The wines are ample, with a dense tannic structure and silky tannins. They are racy, fine and crystalline wines, persistent and with high ageing potential.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable mesoclimatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Vorbourg" exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a thousand nuances, a marked character and a unique personality.

In this warm, sunny grand cru, the wines are characterised by a fine minerality linked to the presence of limestone in the soil and subsoil. The wines are ample and massive thanks to the marls and heavy, finely layered clays, with a fine minerality and a marked salinity. The finish is tannic and earthy. The presence of iron in the soil explains the coloured, intense and stable robe of the red wines.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

"Alsace grand cru Wineck-Schlossberg"

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Wineck-Schlossberg" forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Wineck-Schlossberg" is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

This grand cru is situated on the best-exposed side of a small valley closed on three sides, which gives it a particularly favourable mesoclimate. The shallow soil rests directly on a granitic parent rock (two-mica granite), heavily weathered, conducive to a fairly small and early harvest.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Wineck-Schlossberg" was recognised in 1992. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was

built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term "vendanges tardives" often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term "sélection de grains nobles" are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Wineck-Schlossberg" exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The closed geography protecting the grand cru and its granitic soils give a fine minerality, the wine being accessible from its earliest youth while having an ageing potential of about ten years. Depending on the variety, the wine may be either dry, mineral and complex, or more aromatic, fruity, rich and full-bodied.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

“Alsace grand cru Zinnkoepflé”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Zinnkoepflé” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Zinnkoepflé” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

This terroir is one of the summits of the Alsace vineyard; its slopes are very steep. It is ventilated in late season by the cool currents descending from the Petit Ballon. The Mediterranean, even Caspian-type mesoclimate is accentuated by the arena-like layout of the Vallée Noble. These conditions allow strong ripening and regular overripening of the grapes while respecting their aromatic finesse.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: “the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers’ syndicates.”

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Zinnkoepflé” was recognised in 1992. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. Basically, the only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the “Vin du Rhin”-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”. The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much

complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Zinnkoepflé” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The shelly limestone subsoil, the steep slopes and the low rainfall produce spicy, slightly smoky, saline and mouth-watering wines. They are powerful and generous, supported by a fine acid backbone; their ageing potential easily exceeds a decade.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

“Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Bergbieten”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Bergbieten” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Bergbieten” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

Situated in a very open landscape at the heart of a wide cirque and relatively far from the crystalline Vosges, the vineyard benefits from a warm, dry mesoclimate that guarantees early ripening of the grapes. The presence of dolomitic stones favours the drainage and warming of the gypsiferous clay-marl soil.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Bergbieten" was recognised in 1983. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. Basically, the only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time. The wines of the Altenberg are characterised by aromas of ripe fruit in their youth, which evolve with age into floral aromas, with finesse and subtlety.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines with great freshness.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term "vendanges tardives" often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term "sélection de grains nobles" are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" are

systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Bergbieten" exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The ample structure of the wines, their square acidity and their aromatic persistence are linked to the marly dominance of the lieu-dit. The tannic structure and the characteristic sapidity of the wines are induced by the presence of gypsum, which is the original feature of this appellation.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The work by Médard Barth, "Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine", written in 1958, already praises this lieu-dit, recognised today.

"Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Wolxheim"

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Wolxheim" forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Wolxheim" is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

The Altenberg de Wolxheim grand cru is set around a peak of oolitic limestone. The slopes delimit a full-south-facing amphitheatre, sheltered from the prevailing winds and from the north-east. The result is a warm, dry summer mesoclimate, offset by marls at depth which ensure a regular water supply for the vine.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Wolxheim" was recognised in 1992. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a

rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. Basically, the only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They are vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. Wines claiming these terms must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term "vendanges tardives" often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term "sélection de grains nobles" are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Altenberg de Wolxheim" exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The specific features of this mesoclimate, together with the marl-limestone soil rich in gravel, contribute to the power of the wines, their acid structure blended with salinity, and an aromatic richness that increases over time. The mesoclimate of the Altenberg de Wolxheim, combined with the gravelly marl-limestone soil, favours a continuous and intense vine cycle between budburst and harvest. The wines, from grapes picked ripe, are identified by their natural power and a homogeneous, harmonious palate closely combining a long acidity and a persistent salinity. The aromatic richness increases after a few years, and the wines can be kept for more than ten years.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. In this case, the ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The work by Médard Barth, "Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine", written in 1958, lists numerous historical references to the lieux-dits, including the Altenberg de Wolxheim, notably in the 12th and 13th centuries. It records the qualitative assessments made by 19th-century ampelographers and historians Stoltz, Stoger, Grandidier and Gérard.

"Alsace grand cru Bruderthal"

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Bruderthal" forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Bruderthal" is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

The grand cru is situated in a horseshoe-shaped small valley, protected from north winds by a mountain chain stretching from the Schneeberg to the rock of Mutzig. The very stony shelly limestone (Muschelkalk) soil allows rapid warming. The presence of clay regulates the water regime at depth.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Bruderthal" was recognised in 1992. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from

the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Bruderthal” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The calcareous clay of the soil brings salinity and a dominant natural acidity to the wines, balanced by high levels of ripeness.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

“Alsace grand cru Engelberg”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Engelberg” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Engelberg" is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

The Engelberg grand cru extends over the southern face of the Scharrachberg, a hill overlooking the surrounding landscape. It is made up of the middle belt of the slope (230 m to 300 m altitude), interrupted in its middle by a former limestone quarry. It is situated on well-drained marl-limestone-sandstone soils. The deeper layers allow a regular water supply.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Engelberg" was recognised in 1992. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation, inspired by the historical cores of production. Its total area is thus only 14.80 hectares. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

The wines of the Engelberg are characterised by an acid yet rich structure, based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show fine substance, great aromatic finesse and much complexity. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time without ever losing the airy, fresh side that characterises them. They thus constitute white wines for laying down par excellence.

The following can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines structured by a fine acidity;

- aromatic, fruity, rich and complex wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- wines benefiting from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles", which are sweet wines of very long keeping, endowed with remarkable concentration, great aromatic persistence and a fresh finish. The terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" are systematically

followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory. These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Engelberg" exploits one of its best locations. Nestled in the north of the Alsace Wine Route, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality. They have a very good ageing potential, during which spicy characters, a linear acidity and a saline finish are revealed.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions allow progressive and complete ripening of the grapes, resulting in gastronomic balances, dry or medium-sweet. Concentration on the vine and the development of noble rot also allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The work by Médard Barth, "Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine", written in 1958, already praises this lieu-dit, recognised today.

"Alsace grand cru Frankstein"

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Frankstein" forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-east), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Frankstein" is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

The two-mica granite soil of the Frankstein grand cru is light, stony and sandy. This soil stores heat and lets water filter through, forcing the vine to drive its roots through the fissures in the rock in search of minerals and water.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Frankstein" was recognised in 1992. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white

varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term "vendanges tardives" often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term "sélection de grains nobles" are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Frankstein" exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The minerals drawn from the depths of the granite give the wines of the Frankstein the fine, mouth-watering minerality that characterises them. They express a very straight, vertical acidity that sublimates the finish. This acidity, combined with this minerality, reveals minty aromas. These elements allow the wine to express a particular finesse, complexity and balance that make them great gastronomic wines. The wines of the Frankstein reach their highest expression after a few years in bottle.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The work by Médard Barth, "Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine", written in 1958, already praises this lieu-dit, cited as early as 1291.

"Alsace grand cru Kastelberg"

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Kastelberg" forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Kastelberg" is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

This sunny grand cru rests on schists, unique in the vineyard, which have evolved through metamorphism into a very hard rock, giving very stony, well-drained soils. The schistose rocks, in thin layers, allow deep rooting conducive to normal vigour, even in years of drought.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Kastelberg" was recognised in 1983. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be

supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Kastelberg” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The schist stamps the potential of this grand cru, which is marked by a fine minerality, giving well-structured, racy and frank wines.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

Jean-Louis Stoltz wrote in his work “Premières notions de viticulture et d’œnologie”, published in 1847, that the Kastelberg is a great wine for laying down. It was ranked among the greatest terroirs in the official classification of 1852 in the work “Ampélographie rhénane”. The work by Médard Barth, “Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine”, written in 1958, already praises this lieu-dit, recognised today.

“Alsace grand cru Kirchberg de Barr”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Kirchberg de Barr” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Kirchberg de Barr" is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

This grand cru, with very stony marl-limestone soils (ensuring good drainage and a heat reserve), is sheltered from cold north winds.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Kirchberg de Barr" was recognised in 1983 for white wines, then in 2022 for red wines. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. For white wines, the only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination. For red wines, only pinot noir N is authorised.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare for the production of white wine and 5,000 plants per hectare for the production of red wine. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months. The red wines, for their part, are not enriched in any way. They must undergo a minimum ageing period of 11 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

The white wines:

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time. They evolve towards more complex notes and develop a harmony based on great minerality, finesse and length.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

The red wines:

The wines, with a dark, deep red robe, have a complex nose of black fruit and spices, a broad acidity, volume but great finesse. The finish is long and saline. They have great ageing potential.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Kirchberg de Barr” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

Protected from the north and set on a soil that warms up quickly, the grand cru gives the wines minerality and salinity as well as complexity of acidity. Moderately early to open and slow to ripen, the wines develop over time finesse on the nose, power on the palate, length, freshness and minerality.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

“Alsace grand cru Moenchberg”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Moenchberg” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Moenchberg” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

This grand cru is sunny. The marl-sandstone soil, with significant stoniness, gives a good capacity for warming, aeration and porosity, while retaining good water retention.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Moenchberg" was recognised in 1983. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term "vendanges tardives" often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term "sélection de grains nobles" are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Moenchberg" exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The stoniness of the soils gives the wines a regular, massive and enveloping acidity, bringing salinity, length on the palate and power.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

It is included in the classification of the grand cru terroirs of Alsace by the ampelographer Stoltz, published in 1852. The work by Médard Barth, "Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine", written in 1958, already praises this lieu-dit, recognised today.

"Alsace grand cru Muenchberg"

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Muenchberg" forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Muenchberg" is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

The Muenchberg nestles in a crescent-shaped slope, sheltered from rain and west winds by the Ungersberg. It rests on conglomerates and breccias with volcano-detrital elements. These stony and sandy situations give rise to a poor, very free-draining and rapidly warming soil.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Muenchberg" was recognised in 1992. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum

planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Muenchberg” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The protection of the Ungersberg and the fineness of the soil are reflected in wines of great aromatic power. The sandstones bring finesse and the volcanic ash brings strength and persistence. The Muenchberg wines are characterised by a great, typical minerality that intensifies with ageing.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

“Alsace grand cru Praelatenberg”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Praelatenberg” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Praelatenberg” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

This grand cru is characterised by its metamorphic rock, unique in the Alsace vineyard. The gneiss gives a light, deep siliceous soil that allows rapid and very deep rooting of the vine and favours drainage and deep warming, conducive to good ripening of the grapes.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: “the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers’ syndicates.”

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Praelatenberg” was recognised in 1992. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the “Vin du Rhin”-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”. The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable mesoclimatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Praelatenberg” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a thousand nuances, a marked character and a unique personality.

The gneissic dominance of the substratum gives the wines their crystalline minerality and their freshness.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

“Alsace grand cru Steinklotz”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Steinklotz” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Steinklotz” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

The substratum of shelly limestone (Muschelkalk) and dolomitic Keuper, over a stony subsoil, gives the soils good permeability, favourable to heat accumulation.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: “the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers’ syndicates.”

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Steinklotz” was recognised in 1992. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the “Vin du Rhin”-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”. The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Steinklotz” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and

their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

“Alsace grand cru Wiebelsberg”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Wiebelsberg” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Wiebelsberg” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

The grand cru is characterised by its sandy geology composed solely of Vosges sandstone. The soils nevertheless provide a good water supply. The steep slope makes it a sunny, warm grand cru.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: “the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers’ syndicates.”

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Wiebelsberg” was recognised in 1983. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the “Vin du Rhin”-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”. The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Wiebelsberg” exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

Elegant wines emerge from the fineness of the soils. The acidity is gentle, frank and delicate.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The work by Médard Barth, “Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine”, written in 1958, already praises this lieu-dit, recognised today.

It is included in the classification of the grand cru terroirs of Alsace by the ampelographer Stoltz, published in 1852.

“Alsace grand cru Winzenberg”

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Winzenberg” forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace”.

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin “Alsace grand cru Winzenberg” is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

Situated on a steep south-east-facing slope, the vineyard is established on a shallow soil where the two-mica granitic rock outcrops in places. This soil, which warms up quickly and is sensitive to drought, requires rigorous control of yields and makes it a relatively late-ripening vineyard.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Winzenberg" was recognised in 1992. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. The only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, muscat à petits grains blancs B, muscat à petits grains roses Rs, muscat ottonel B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term "vendanges tardives" often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term "sélection de grains nobles" are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Winzenberg" exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The mesoclimate is favourable to the birth of wines favouring elegance and finesse. Its geological specificity gives the wine a liveliness as well as a crystalline purity detectable at every level of tasting.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The work by Médard Barth, "Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine", written in 1958, already praises this lieu-dit, recognised today.

A parchment already mentions the Winzenberg in a deed of 1477.

"Alsace grand cru Zotzenberg"

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Zotzenberg" forms an integral part of the Alsace vineyard, its geographical area being set in the heart of it. It is delimited within the area of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The Vosges massif offering protection against the humid, cool north-westerly winds, the vineyard finds its ideal conditions of establishment on the well-exposed (east to south-west), steeply sloping hillsides of the sub-Vosgian hills. The delimitation therefore refers to this typical landscape.

The controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Zotzenberg" is characterised by soils belonging to a single geo-pedological unit associated with a most favourable mesoclimate.

The grand cru is situated on the south/south-east slope of a sub-Vosgian hill. The strength of the Zotzenberg is its geology of very dense marls on a limestone base. It is well drained and ensures a balanced water supply.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Having noticed very early the specific features that certain lieux-dits gave to their viticulture and their wines, Alsace wine-growers made the most of these differences by communicating for centuries on the origin of the wines and, more recently, by stating the geographical origin of the products on the bottle. This usage is thus enshrined in article 2 of the ordinance of 2 November 1945 in its original wording: "the sub-regional, communal and local designations of origin of Alsace shall be the subject, within the production area, of delimitations on the proposal of the local wine-growers' syndicates."

As a translation of this usage, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Zotzenberg" was recognised in 1992. The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation inspired by the historical cores of production. This recognition was built around the white varieties. Basically, the only varieties selected are the following: riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G and sylvaner B. They may be vinified and marketed under their respective denomination.

Since the law of 5 July 1972, the wines must be bottled within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments, traditionally in the "Vin du Rhin"-type flute described in the decree of 1955.

The vineyard, trained on high trellises in order to benefit from an optimal leaf area, is subject to more restrictive production conditions than the controlled designation of origin "Alsace". The minimum planting density is 4,500 plants per hectare. The grapes are harvested by hand. Wines benefiting from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" come from overripe and fragile grapes, also harvested by hand. These wines must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

White wines for laying down par excellence, they are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. The name of the appellation may be supplemented by customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned. They show great substance, much complexity and strong aromatic power with various nuances. Of great length on the palate, they gain in complexity over time.

Four types of wine can be distinguished:

- dry, mineral wines;

- aromatic, fruity, rich, full-bodied wines.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term "vendanges tardives" often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term "sélection de grains nobles" are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. Wines benefiting from these last two terms are sweet wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. The terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" are systematically followed by the denominations Gewurztraminer, Pinot gris and Riesling, and the indication of the vintage is compulsory.

3° – Causal interactions

Drawing on the favourable climatic conditions that characterise the Alsace vineyard, the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Zotzenberg" exploits one of its best locations. Nestled within the picturesque Alsace landscape, the vineyard allows the production of wines of high expression, with a marked character and a unique personality.

The dense marls allow the production of massive, rich wines with an elegant salinity and great aromatic finesse.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. The ageing provided for in the specification allows the wines to improve.

By adopting rigorous production rules, such as maintaining a large leaf area and manual harvesting, Alsace wine-growers preserve the assertive character of wines recognised for their complexity and their aptitude for long keeping. They constitute the top of the range of this region. They are wines that command higher prices than the wines of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace".

The work by Médard Barth, "Der Rebbau des Elsass und die Absatzgebieten seiner Weine", written in 1958, already praises this lieu-dit, recognised today.

XI. – Transitional measures

1° – Delimited parcel area

On a transitional basis, vine-planted parcels excluded from the delimited parcel area "Alsace grand cru Kaefferkopf", as identified by their cadastral references and their area by the competent national committee of the National Institute of Origin and Quality at its session of 6 and 7 September 2006, may benefit for their harvest from the right to the controlled designation of origin "Alsace grand cru Kaefferkopf" until they are grubbed up and at the latest until the 2031 harvest inclusive, provided that they meet the conditions set out in the present specification.

2° – Training method

For white wines: the planting density and the trellising and pruning rules, with the exception of the rule relating to the distance between the carrying wire and the attachment wire, do not apply to vines planted before 1 September 2000. These vines are trained with a maximum of 18 free eyes per plant. They continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin until they are grubbed up and at the latest until the 2025 harvest.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, one of the controlled designations of origin covered by the present specification is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid controlled designation of origin is entered.

2° – Particular provisions

a) – Any optional indication whose use, under Community provisions, may be regulated by the Member States is entered on the labels in characters whose dimensions, in height, width and thickness, are not greater than those of the characters of the appellation.

b) – The use of two or more customary denominations on the same label is prohibited.

c) – The vintage must appear together with the name of the appellation in the harvest and stock declarations, on the accompanying documents, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever.

d) – White wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, one of the 51 controlled designations of origin "Alsace Grand Cru – lieu-dit" is claimed, with the exception of the terms Vendanges Tardives and Sélection de Grains Nobles, and which are presented under the said appellation, may not be offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless the indication of the sugar content, as defined by European regulations, is entered in very conspicuous characters in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever.

e) – Wines liable to benefit from the terms "vendanges tardives" or "sélection de grains nobles" must be presented:

- with the indication of the vintage;

- and with one of the following customary denominations: Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot Gris, Riesling.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1. Prior declaration of parcel assignment

A prior declaration of parcel assignment must be lodged with the defence and management body before 1 March of the year of harvest. This declaration specifies:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the identity of the operator receiving the grapes, where applicable;

- for each parcel: the cadastral reference, the area, the grape variety.

The operator may declare to the defence and management body that they renounce producing the controlled designation of origin at the latest on 15 August preceding the harvest. They specify the PDO finally produced on the parcels concerned.

2. Prior declaration of parcel assignment for vines liable to benefit from the term "vendanges tardives" or "sélection de grains nobles"

The prior declaration of parcel assignment is lodged with the defence and management body before 1 March of the year of harvest. This declaration specifies:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the identity of the operator receiving the grapes, where applicable;

- for each parcel: the cadastral reference, the area, the grape variety.

3. Declaration relating to vinification vat capacity

Every operator vinifying wines of the controlled designation of origin sends the defence and management body, at the latest on 31 August of the year of harvest, a declaration relating to vinification vat capacity. The cellar plan annexed to the identification declaration may serve as the declaration relating to vinification vat capacity. This declaration is renewable by tacit renewal, unless changes are notified by the operator before 31 August of the year of harvest. In the event of a sale of grapes, this declaration specifies the destination of the harvest, in particular on the basis of the inter-trade contract entered into.

4. Claim declaration

The claim declaration is lodged with the defence and management body at least 15 days before the first exit of products from the vinification cellar and at the latest 60 days after the date of placing on the market for the consumer.

It indicates:

- the designation claimed;

- the volume of the wine;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the name and address of the applicant;

- the place of storage of the wine.

It is accompanied by a copy of the harvest declaration and, as the case may be, a copy of the production declaration or an extract of the stock accounts for buyers of grapes and musts.

5. Prior declaration of collections

Every operator wishing to sell in bulk a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin sends the approved control body a transaction declaration for the lot concerned between the day the transaction is contracted and at least eight days before collection. If the volume actually collected differs by more or less than 10 % from the volume indicated when the contract was concluded, the operator makes a correction available to the approved control body.

6. Fallback declaration

Every operator marketing a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin under a more general appellation must declare it to the defence and management body and to the approved control body within a maximum period of 15 days after this fallback.

7. Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin must declare it to the defence and management body and to the approved control body within a maximum period of 15 days after this downgrading.

II. – Keeping of registers

No particular provisions.

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	
Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area	Documentary or field checks
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1 – Management of the vineyard	
Average maximum load per parcel	Check in the field
B2 – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes	
Ripeness of the grapes: sugar content and minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume (including the check of the specific conditions concerning the traditional terms Vendanges Tardives and Sélection de Grains Nobles)	Documentary or field checks
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
Packaged wines	Analytical and organoleptic examination

II. – References concerning the control structure

Institut National de l'Origine et de la Qualité (INAO)

TSA 30003, 93555 MONTREUIL Cedex

Tel.: (33) (0)1.73.30.38.00 – Fax: (33) (0)1.73.30.38.04 – Email: contact@inao.gouv.fr

Compliance with the present specification is checked on the basis of an approved control plan, by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence that has received delegation from the INAO.